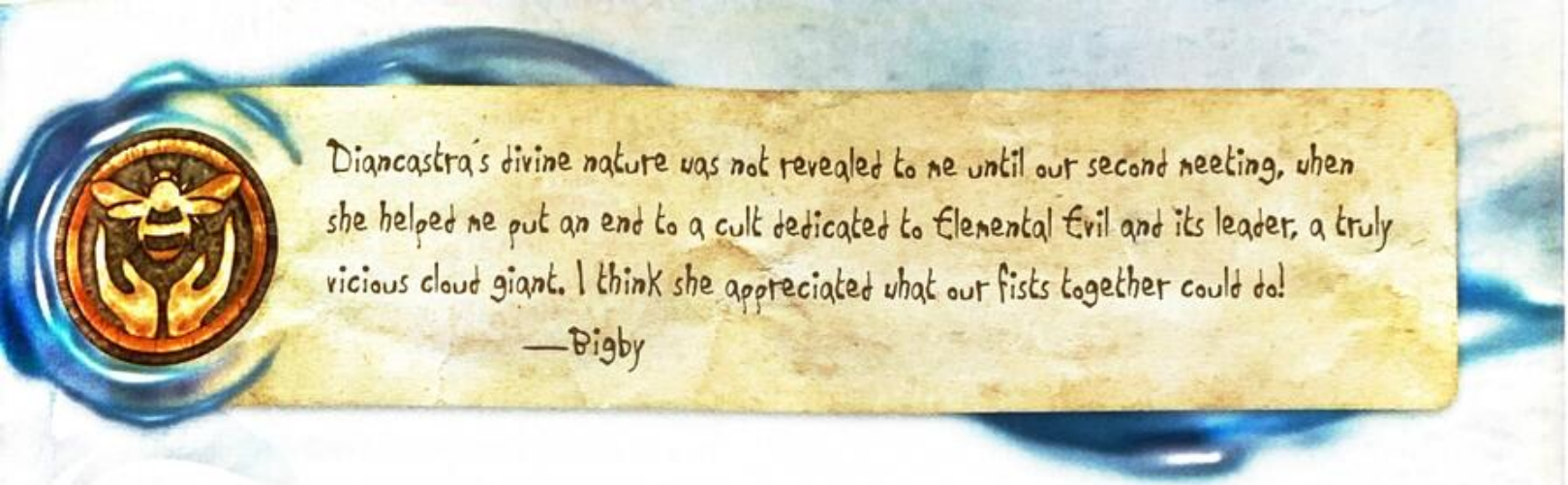


Diancastra's divine nature was not revealed to me until our second meeting, when she helped me put an end to a cult dedicated to Elemental Evil and its leader, a truly vicious cloud giant. I think she appreciated what our fists together could do!

—Bigby

CHAPTER 3

GIANT ADVENTURES

THIS CHAPTER, INTENDED FOR THE DUNGEON Master, is full of tables and inspiration you can use to build encounters, adventures, and entire worlds and campaigns that give giants a properly giant-sized role. The chapter has three parts:

"Encounters" provides tools to help you build encounters involving giants and the creatures that frequently accompany them. You can use the tables in this section to populate the giant-themed locations in chapter 4 or any other encounter.

"Adventures" includes adventure hooks and other tools you can use to craft an adventure involving giants and their worlds.

"Campaigns" helps you establish the role of giants in your game world and place these mighty peoples—past or present—in the forefront of your campaign.

ENCOUNTERS

Giants are social creatures, often living together in families or bands, or accompanied by smaller followers. Even when they live in isolation, they often keep pets or servants. While an encounter might consist of a single giant, more typical encounters include a mix of one or more giants with other creatures.

This section is loaded with inspiration to help you create such encounters, whether you're planning a single encounter or populating a giant-filled enclave. The tables are broken into two categories: "Giant-kind Encounters" and "Connected Creatures." The first includes tables for each of the six main families of giants, plus death giants and fomorians. The second covers a variety of other creatures often found alongside giants, including other creatures of the Giant type.

USING THE TABLES

When a creature's name appears in **bold** type, that's a visual cue pointing you to its stat block. Creatures marked with an asterisk (*) appear in this book. Those marked with a dagger (†) appear in *Mordenkainen Presents: Monsters of the Multiverse*. (Where those monsters appear, a note to the table tells you what to do if you don't have that book.) All other creatures are described in the *Monster Manual*. If a Humanoid creature's kind is not specified, it can be any kind of Humanoid you choose.

Giants are dangerous foes. The encounter tables in this section are most suitable for use with characters in the third tier of play (levels 11–16). If you're creating giant-themed encounters for lower-level characters, you might use more dangerous creatures in the background to establish the setting of the adventure, or use them in a nonhostile capacity. For example, if you're creating encounters for a 6th-level party, a fight against two storm giants would make for a dreadfully one-sided battle. Instead, the characters could witness the giants in an altercation from a distance, foreshadowing a conflict that will threaten all the smaller folk in the region. Or you could decide the giants are indifferent or friendly toward the characters, leading to a dramatic interaction that might offer hooks to adventures more appropriate to your party's level. See the "Giants and Tiers of Play" sidebar for more advice.

ENCOUNTER CONTEXT

Each table entry presents a short description of the creatures in an encounter and what they're doing. Use these ideas as inspiration to fit the encounter into the location you're populating. If that context doesn't make sense for the situation you're building, consider using the context to inspire the creature's general motivation. For example, if you roll a 12 on the Cloud Giant Encounters table, it might not make sense for a cloud giant to be searching for the

Misty Vale (an enclave described in chapter 4) in that particular location. You might decide there is a clue to the vale's location in this place, or you can simply treat the giant's search for the Misty Vale as an overarching goal, regardless of what the giant is doing when the encounter occurs. That choice can influence how you roleplay the giant if the characters engage in conversation.

Initial Attitude

Each creature on these tables includes a suggested attitude roll in parentheses after its name. To randomly determine the initial attitude of creatures in an encounter, roll the dice specified in the parentheses, then refer to the appropriate line of the Initial Attitudes table.

Initial Attitudes

Attitude Roll Total	Initial Attitude
4 or lower	Hostile
5–8	Indifferent
9 or higher	Friendly

Giants and Tiers of Play

The giants of the ordning are appropriate threats for characters who have significant experience. When you plan giant encounters, pay attention to how much damage the giants can deal in a single attack. Many giants can kill lower-level characters with a single hit.

Use the guidelines in the *Dungeon Master's Guide* or *Xanathar's Guide to Everything* to build appropriately challenging encounters for your party. The guidelines here can help you plan adventures featuring giants for each tier of play:

First Tier (Levels 1–4). Ogres are the most suitable Giant opponents for characters in the first tier of play, and characters at level 4 might face a single hill giant. A lone hill giant can feel confident bullying (or eating) the inhabitants of a village, but more powerful giants (and larger groups) set their sights higher.

Second Tier (Levels 5–10). A single stone, frost, fire, or cloud giant is an appropriate challenge for characters in this tier. Near the top of this tier, characters might challenge two hill giants or possibly a storm giant. The intrusion of these giants into settled lands is a threat that a whole kingdom or region notices.

Third Tier (Levels 11–16). Three to five hill giants are an appropriate challenge for characters at this level, as are two to three stone or frost giants, two fire or cloud giants, or a single storm giant. Large groups of giants, when they are organized toward a single purpose, can determine the fate of nations.

Fourth Tier (Levels 17–20). Mighty characters in the fourth tier can challenge as many as eight hill giants, four to five stone or frost giants, three to five fire or cloud giants, or two to three storm giants. When giants in significant numbers work toward a common cause, they can alter the nature of worlds.

If an attitude doesn't fit what the creature is doing, you can either ignore the attitude or shape the encounter to match it. For example, if you roll an indifferent or friendly attitude for a creature that is hunting prey, you might decide the hunter simply doesn't find the characters to be a tasty treat. If the creature is sapient, it could ask the characters if they've seen which way its quarry has gone.

Giantkind Encounters

This section includes encounter tables themed around each of the six kinds of giants in the *Monster Manual*, plus death giants (found in chapter 6) and fomorians. Each table includes giants as well as creatures that might be found in or around the homes of giants, including those commonly associated with giants as pets (such as spotted lions for cloud giants and dire wolves for hill giants).

Cloud Giant Encounters

Cloud giants and related creatures thrive where there is fantastic wealth to be earned, plundered, or swindled; where there are secrets to be uncovered; and where diplomacy or guile can carry the day.

Cloud Giant Encounters

d12†	Encounter
1	1 **cloud giant** seeking to learn the secrets of 1 **spectral cloud*** (attitude for both: 1d8)
2	1 **cloud giant** (attitude: 1d12) trading riddles with 1 **djinni** (attitude: 1d6 + 4)
3	1d6 **nothics** (attitude: 2d4 + 2) coveting cloud giant arcana
4	1 **cloud giant destiny gambler*** (attitude: 1d8 + 2) conferring with 1 **mage** (attitude: 1d12)
5	1d4 **doppelganger** spies (attitude: 1d8 + 1) posing as servants while they try to glean secrets
6	2 **cloud giants** (attitude: 1d10 + 2; roll separately for each) engaged in a wager or battle of wits
7	1 **cloud giant** (attitude: 1d10 + 2) training 1 **spotted lion*** (attitude: 1d4 + 1)
8	1 **cloud giant of Evil Air*** bossing around 2 **air elementals** (attitude for all: 1d6)
9	1 **cloud giant** (attitude: 1d8 + 1) hunting with 1 **wyvern** (attitude: 1d6)
10	2d4 **goliath giant-kin*** (attitude: 1d6 + 4) trying to retrieve an **owlbear** (attitude: 1d6) on a rampage after running away from its giant owner
11	1d4 + 1 **vampiric mists**† (attitude: 1d4 + 1) lurking in a fog bank
12	1 **cloud giant smiling one**† (attitude: 1d10) seeking the Misty Vale (see chapter 4)

†Monsters marked with a dagger (†) appear in *Monsters of the Multiverse*. Roll a d10 if you don't have that book.
*See chapter 6.

Death Giant Encounters

The Death Giant Encounters table is appropriate for places steeped in gloom, whether within the Shadowfell or touched by that plane's sorrowful influence. The creatures on this table might populate places where giants fell into despair, sites where giants delved too deeply into necromantic magic, or areas where the Negative Plane's life-consuming influence seeps into the world.

Death Giant Encounters

d10†	Encounter
1	1d6 **skeletons** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) rebuilding a destroyed idol at the disinterested direction of 1 **death giant reaper*** (attitude: 1d10 + 2)
2	1 **death giant shrouded one*** (attitude: 1d8) wringing historical facts from a **ghost** (attitude: 1d6 + 4) that weeps over the memories
3	1d4 **wraiths** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) puzzling over a trinket that reminds them of their past lives
4	1 **death giant reaper*** (attitude: 1d6) stalking a creature to offer its soul to the Raven Queen
5	1 **stone giant** (attitude: 1d12) negotiating with 1 **death giant reaper*** (attitude: 1d8)
6	1 **revenant** (attitude: 1d10) bent on revenging itself on its killer—a death giant
7	1 **death giant reaper*** (attitude: 1d8 + 2) brooding over ancient carvings
8	1 **death giant reaper*** exile (attitude: 1d8 + 1) searching for a creature it killed whose soul escaped the Raven Queen's clutches (the creature is now a revenant)
9	1 **death giant shrouded one*** (attitude: 1d6) debating 1 **devourer**† (attitude: 1d4 + 1) on the finer points of souls
10	1 **nightwalker**† (attitude: 1d4 + 1) striding in search of a death giant's home or trappings

†Monsters marked with a dagger (†) appear in *Monsters of the Multiverse*. Roll a d8 if you don't have that book.

*See chapter 6.

Death giants are aptly named. Though they are not themselves undead, they wear death like a shroud. Its stink lingers around them, and even sunlight seems to dim in their presence.

—Bigby



Death giants haunt the Shadowfell and other places where death's influence is strong.

ILLUS. REYNA

Fire Giant Encounters

Fire giants and their minions strive to create the strongest and finest crafts and fortresses. These giants can be found in any area rich in workable resources, particularly metal, as well as places where they can test their creations in battle.

Fire Giant Encounters

d12†	Encounter
1	1 **fire giant of Evil Fire*** overseeing the rampage of 2 **fire elementals** (attitude for all: 1d4 + 1)
2	1 **fire giant forgecaller*** using a **xorn** (attitude for both: 1d10) to track down mineral deposits
3	1 **fire giant** (attitude: 1d10) feeding 1d4 + 1 **hell hounds** (attitude: 1d6)
4	2d4 **rust monsters** (attitude: 1d10, automatically hostile toward anyone using metal objects) following the scent of iron
5	1 **firegaunt*** (attitude: 1d6) stalking its former fellows who betrayed it
6	2 **trolls** (attitude: 1d10 + 3) terrified to disobey the orders of 1 **fire giant** (attitude: 1d6)
7	1 soot-caked **iron golem** (attitude: 1d6)
8	1 **fire giant** smith (attitude: 1d10) working on a breastplate sized for a Large creature
9	2d4 **goliath giant-kin*** (attitude: 1d8 + 2) hauling a load of ore from a mine
10	3 **fire giants** (attitude: 1d6 + 1) battling an **adult red dragon** (attitude: 1d6)
11	1 **fire giant** (attitude: 1d8 + 1) leading 4 **firenewt warriors†** (attitude: 1d8 + 1) riding **giant striders†** (attitude: 1d8 + 3)
12	1 **fire giant dreadnought†** (attitude: 1d6) on guard

†Monsters marked with a dagger (†) appear in *Monsters of the Multiverse*. Roll a d10 if you don't have that book.
*See chapter 6.

Fomorian Encounters

The Fomorian Encounters table presents encounters that can occur in underground regions or at surface locations suffering an invasion from the depths. These encounters also fit well for places warped by the strange corruption of the Far Realm. Using these encounters to supplement another table can hint at deeper threats that are just beginning to burst through the fabric of the multiverse.

Fomorian Encounters

d10†	Encounter
1	1 **fomorian noble*** (attitude: 1d8 + 2) studying a treatise on arcane phenomena
2	1d4 + 2 **hook horrors** (attitude: 1d6) banging their hooks on rocks or their bodies
3	1 **fomorian** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) with 5 **commoner** captives (attitude: 1d8 + 4)
4	1 **fomorian deep crawler*** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) scuttling in search of victims
5	1 **fomorian** (attitude: 1d10) supervising 1 **umber hulk** (attitude: 1d6) as it digs new tunnels
6	2d4 **flumphs** (attitude: 1d8 + 4) trying to avoid 1 **ettin ceremorph*** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) while feeding on the ettin's psionic energy
7	2 **mind flayers** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) telepathically discussing the finer points of a brain they just shared
8	1 **fomorian** (attitude: 1d8) contemplating a gemstone it thinks is floating but that is actually suspended inside 1 **gelatinous cube** (attitude: 1d4 + 1)
9	1 **fomorian warlock of the dark*** (attitude: 1d8 + 2) seeking omens in the twisting slither of 1 **neothelid†** (attitude: 1d8)
10	1 **ulitharid†** (attitude: 1d6) bargaining with 1 **fomorian** (attitude: 1d8) to establish a new mind flayer colony in the fomorian's territory

†Monsters marked with a dagger (†) appear in *Monsters of the Multiverse*. Roll a d8 if you don't have that book.
*See chapter 6.

Frost Giant Encounters

The Frost Giant Encounters table includes encounters suitable for arctic regions or regions where the activity of frost giants has magically cooled the climate.

Pick a Giant, Any Giant

If you'd like to randomly determine the kind of giants that are dominant in a location, roll on the Giantkind Encounters table. You could also roll twice and use the resulting two tables to create either a cooperative or rival relationship between the indicated giants.

Giantkind Encounters

d8	Encounter Table
1	Cloud Giant Encounters
2	Death Giant Encounters
3	Fire Giant Encounters
4	Fomorian Encounters
5	Frost Giant Encounters
6	Hill Giant Encounters
7	Stone Giant Encounters
8	Storm Giant Encounters

Frost Giant Encounters

d12†	Encounter
1	1 **frost giant** (attitude: 1d8 + 1) leading 1 **titanothere*** (attitude: 1d10) loaded with fur and timber
2	1 **young silver dragon** (attitude: 1d10 + 3) tracking a frost giant raiding party
3	1 **frost giant** hunting with 1d4 **winter wolves** (attitude for all: 1d6)
4	2 **frost giants** (attitude: 1d6 + 2) burying a body that rises as 1 **frostmourn*** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) in the process
5	2d4 **giant goats** (attitude: 1d6 + 4) wandering about with chewed tethers
6	1 **troll** (attitude: 1d10 + 2) anxiously searching for the lost goats it tends for a frost giant tribe
7	1 **frost giant** (attitude: 1d8 + 1) building a wind shelter from ice blocks
8	1 **frost giant ice shaper*** (attitude: 1d10) performing a sacrifice to Thrym
9	1 bored **troll amalgam*** (attitude: 1d10) throwing its arm at a stack of boulders
10	2d4 **goliath giant-kin*** (attitude: 1d8 + 3) on a pilgrimage
11	1 **ogre bolt launcher**† and 1d4 + 2 **ogres** (attitude for all: 1d6) bringing spoils from a raid to their frost giant leader
12	1 **frost giant everlasting one**† (attitude: 1d4 + 1) plotting revenge against the tribe that exiled it

†Monsters marked with a dagger (†) appear in *Monsters of the Multiverse*. Roll a d10 if you don't have that book.
*See chapter 6.

Hill Giant Encounters

d12†	Encounter
1	2 **hill giants** charging at each other until their heads collide, while 4 **ogres** (attitude for all: 1d6 + 3) watch and cheer
2	1 **hill giant avalancher*** (attitude: 1d8 + 2) searching exasperatedly for a giant goose that stole from the giant's bag
3	2 **hill giants** (attitude: 1d10) trading broken weapons they've collected
4	1 **hill giant** and 3 **ogres** (attitude for all: 1d12) taking turns bowling ettin skulls at sticks stuck in the ground
5	1 **hill giant** (attitude: 1d6 + 3) dejectedly trying to reassemble a small stone building it accidentally demolished
6	1d4 **otyughs** (attitude: 1d10) in a waste pit where hill giants dispose of feast remnants
7	1 **hill giant** singing beautifully for 1d4 **dire wolves** (attitude for all: 1d10 + 2)
8	2 **hill giants** (attitude: 1d8) roasting a bear over a burning wagon and excessively seasoning it with spices plundered from the wagon
9	2d4 **goliath giant-kin*** (attitude: 1d8 + 2) enjoying a feast
10	1 **hill giant** (attitude: 1d6) asking for food from a gang of 2d4 **bugbears** (attitude: 1d6 + 2)
11	1 **flind**† (attitude: 1d4 + 1) leading a bloodthirsty party of 5 **gnoll hunters**† (attitude: 1d6)
12	1 **mouth of Grolantor**† (attitude: 1d6) eating everything in reach, including the landscape

†Monsters marked with a dagger (†) appear in *Monsters of the Multiverse*. Roll a d10 if you don't have that book.
*See chapter 6.

Hill Giant Encounters

The Hill Giant Encounters table presents hill giants alongside other creatures driven by hunger. These encounters are good for straightforward adventures that don't focus on twists and guile. These creatures simply seek to indulge their endless hunger.

Often, the most dangerous thing about a community of giants is the scattering of outcasts lingering on its outskirts, like wolves keeping a respectful distance from a campfire but unable to stray too far.

—Bigby

You could describe many giant communities the same way: unable to stray from the glory they have lost, but unwilling to approach it again.

—Diancastra

Stone Giant Encounters

The Stone Giant Encounters table presents stone giants and creatures that might appear in areas they inhabit, either by choice or because of geography. Sapient creatures might be drawn to stone giant artwork and stone shaping, or they might be caught in the giants' passion for seeking truth and insight from their dreams.

These creatures can appear on the surface rather than in typical stone giant tunnels. Perhaps they're following the giants on a quest to the "dream world" that is the surface, or maybe they're trading and conferring with such giants when they emerge.

Stone Giant Encounters

d12†	Encounter
1	1 **stone giant** and 1 **xorn** (attitude for both: 1d10) hunting for gems, much the way surface peoples hunt for truffles
2	1 **stone giant rockspeaker*** conferring with 2 **galeb duhrs** (attitude for all: 1d8 + 4)
3	1 **stone giant** (attitude: 1d12) playing fetch with 1 **carrion crawler** (attitude: 1d4 + 1)
4	2d4 **goliath giant-kin*** (attitude: 1d10) practicing throwing rocks
5	1 **stone giant** arguing with 1 **minotaur** (attitude for both: 1d12) about the best path for a maze they're designing
6	1 **stone giant** (attitude: 1d6 + 4) dreamily carving a slab of rock into an abstract hill giant figure
7	1 **cairnwight*** (attitude: 1d8 + 2) searching for treasure stolen from its tomb
8	2d4 cave bears (**polar bears**; attitude: 1d6 + 1) on patrol
9	1 **stone giant of Evil Earth*** (attitude: 1d6) arguing theology with 2 **stone giants** (attitude: 1d12)
10	2d6 dwarf prospectors (**veterans**; attitude: 1d12) delving into areas full of stone giant dream carvings
11	2 **korreds**† (attitude: 1d8) exchanging their cut hair with 1 **stone giant** (attitude: 1d10) for stone and gem artwork
12	1 **stone giant dreamwalker**† (attitude: 1d8 + 2) collecting objects and creatures to fuse into its body

†Monsters marked with a dagger (†) appear in *Monsters of the Multiverse*. Roll a d10 if you don't have that book.
*See chapter 6.

Storm Giant Encounters

The Storm Giant Encounters table includes storm giants as well as creatures that relate to or resonate with storm giant themes. Storm giants usually remain solitary, but they can get tangled in events that relate to prophecies and omens. These encounters might happen anywhere, at any time, and can be a sign on their own of momentous events to come.

Storm Giant Encounters

d12†	Encounter
1	1 **storm giant tempest caller*** (attitude: 1d8 + 2) communing with a lightning-lit face in a thundercloud
2	1 **storm giant** riding 1 **aerosaur*** (attitude for both: 1d10)
3	1 **lightning hulk*** (attitude: 1d6) reveling in destruction
4	1 **storm giant** hunting or fishing with 1 **griffon** or **giant octopus** companion (attitude for both: 1d10 + 2)
5	1 **storm giant** (attitude: 1d12) patiently explaining a Giant rune to 1d4 **ogres** (attitude: 1d10)
6	2 **storm giants** (attitude: 1d8 + 2) moving pieces on a massive game board according to events that haven't happened yet
7	1d4 **behirs** (attitude: 1d8 + 1) stalking storm giants
8	2d4 **goliath giant-kin*** (attitude: 1d8 + 3) meditating in hopes of receiving a vision or prophetic word
9	1 **storm herald*** conferring with 1 **kraken** (attitude for both: 1d8 + 1)
10	1 **adult blue dragon** (attitude: 1d6) seeking the secret refuge of a storm giant oracle who is an ancient enemy
11	1 **kraken priest**† and 3 **deep scions**† (attitude for all: 1d4 + 1) studying storm giant runes
12	1 **storm giant quintessent**† (attitude: 1d12) reading omens in the migration paths of 2 **rocs** or **killer whales** (attitude: 1d6 + 4)

†Monsters marked with a dagger (†) appear in *Monsters of the Multiverse*. Roll a d10 if you don't have that book.
*See chapter 6.

Connected Creatures

The encounter tables in this section include a variety of monsters grouped according to themes that might flavor a giant enclave or encounter. Combined with the encounters from the "Giantkind Encounters" section, you can create a series of events with a distinctive flavor.

Dinosaur World Encounters

Use the Dinosaur World Encounters table to populate "lost worlds" sequestered from the Material Plane during a long-forgotten era when dinosaurs ruled the world (with or without the presence of giants), or bustling settlements where giants use domesticated dinosaurs as companions and beasts of burden—perhaps using deinonychus as hunting hounds or herding triceratops like cattle.

Domesticated dinosaurs might have a variety of trappings—markings, brands, harnesses, collars, or saddles—that reflect the culture and nature of the giants who care for them. Hill giants might use crude twisted rope or rough leather cords, while storm giants could use bridles of spun copper that spark when touched or masterfully woven seaweed saddles.

Dinosaur World Encounters

d10[1]	Encounter
1	1 **regisaur*** (attitude: 1d8) hunting
2	1 **altisaur*** (attitude: 1d8 + 2) grazing
3	2d4 **ankylosaurus** (attitude: 1d8) digging a nest
4	2d4 **allosaurus** (attitude: 1d6) engaged in territorial threat displays
5	1 **aerosaur*** (attitude: 1d8) slowly circling
6	1 **ceratops*** (attitude: 1d6) rampaging
7	1d4 + 1 **triceratops** (attitude: 1d6 + 4) grazing
8	1 **tyrannosaurus rex** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) pursuing prey
9	2d4 **brontosaurus**[†] (attitude: 1d6 + 4) migrating
10	1d4 **stegosaurus**[†] (attitude: 1d8 + 2) trying to help an additional one that is stuck in thick mud

[†]Monsters marked with a dagger (†) appear in *Monsters of the Multiverse*. Roll a d8 if you don't have that book.
*See chapter 6.

Elemental Encounters

Use the four Elemental Encounters tables to populate areas suffused with the elemental and magical nature of giants or places where the Elemental Planes break into the Material Plane. The creatures on these tables might be connected to the cults of Elemental Evil (described in chapter 2). Magical conduits might draw creatures from the Elemental

A place where giants and dinosaurs live in peaceable harmony sounds like some kind of paradise. I'd very much like to visit such a place.

—Bigby



Giants and dinosaurs are both ancient creatures belonging to a long-forgotte

QUINTIN GLEIM



A whirlpool from the Plane of Water is the center of this storm giant enclave.

Planes and disgorge them within powerful storms, deep chasms, tumultuous wildfires, or ocean maelstroms. Elemental forces might also come to the world to oppose their elemental rivals from opposite planes: air versus earth or fire versus water.

The elemental forces of air are most commonly connected with cloud and storm giants. Those of earth are typically associated with hill and stone giants. Elemental fire is closely tied to fire giants, and elemental water is typically connected to cloud and frost giants.

The Elemental Water Encounters table can be useful in any aquatic environment, not just one where the Plane of Water extends its reach. An ancient giant enclave sunken in some great catastrophe or a storm giant retreat beneath the sea is an appropriate locale for these encounters.

Elemental Air Encounters

d12†	Encounter
1	1d3 **mist hulks*** (attitude: 1d8) wandering about, wallowing in regret
2	2d4 **aarakocra** (attitude: 1d10 + 2) flying in formation
3	1d4 **air elementals** (attitude: 1d8 + 2) kicking up dust and debris
4	1d4 Evil Air cultists (**veterans**; attitude: 1d8) riding **hippogriffs** (attitude: 1d8 + 2) and accosting travelers
5	1 **invisible stalker** (attitude: 1d6) looking for a particular magic item
6	1 **young gold dragon** (attitude: 1d8 + 4) dancing in high wind currents
7	1 **cloud giant of Evil Air*** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) terrorizing the skies
8	1 **djinni** (attitude: 1d12 + 2) examining shattered gargoyle remains
9	2d4 **griffons** (attitude: 1d10) with blue and gray coloring soaring
10	1 **lightning hulk*** (attitude: 1d8) crackling in a jagged path
11	1d3 **air elemental myrmidons**† (attitude: 1d6) on high alert
12	1 **elder tempest**† (attitude: 1d6 + 2) reveling in a storm

†Monsters marked with a dagger (†) appear in *Monsters of the Multiverse*. Roll a d10 if you don't have that book.
*See chapter 6.

Elemental Earth Encounters

d12†	Encounter
1	2d4 **gargoyles** (attitude: 1d8) keeping watch, crouching utterly still
2	2 **galeb duhrs** (attitude: 1d10) singing a rumbling bass duet to an audience of boulders
3	1 **mud hulk*** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) futilely trying to bury 1 **dust hulk*** (attitude: 1d12) in piles of muck
4	2 **bulettes** (attitude: 1d6 + 2) burrowing and breaching the surface in an intricate dance
5	2 **xorn** (attitude: 1d10) gliding through the ground
6	1 **roper** lurking near its brood of 1d6 **piercers** (attitude for all: 1d4 + 1)
7	1 **stone giant of Evil Earth*** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) seeking surface-world creatures or structures to destroy
8	1 **medusa** (attitude: 1d10) anxiously planning its next move
9	1d3 **earth elementals** (attitude: 1d6 + 2) examining a crystal formation
10	1 **dao** (attitude: 1d8) shaking down 2 dwarf miners (**veterans**; attitude: 1d10 + 2) for "taxes"
11	2 **earth elemental myrmidons**† (attitude: 1d8) stoically patrolling
12	1 **zaratan**† (attitude: 1d6 + 2) lumbering through the area, heedless of damage it causes

†Monsters marked with a dagger (†) appear in *Monsters of the Multiverse*. Roll a d10 if you don't have that book.
*See chapter 6.

Elemental Fire Encounters

d12†	Encounter
1	1 **salamander** heating its spear over 2d4 **fire snakes** (attitude for all: 1d6 + 3) in a tangled coil
2	2 **cinder hulks*** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) seeking to burn everything in their path
3	1d4 + 1 **smoke mephits** (attitude: 1d6) following 1 **fire elemental** (attitude: 1d8) as it cuts a blazing swath
4	1 **efreeti** and its 1d4 dwarf minions (**thugs**; attitude for all: 1d4 + 1) demanding tribute
5	2d6 **magmins** (attitude: 1d6) searching for something sizable to burn
6	2d4 **azers** assembling pieces of a **helmed horror** (attitude for all: 1d10)
7	2 **fire elementals** (attitude: 1d8) flitting adoringly around a bonfire
8	1 **young red dragon** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) picking through the remains of a burned-out caravan
9	1 **fire giant of Evil Fire*** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) conquering in the name of Imix, Prince of Evil Fire
10	1 **flameskull** (attitude: 1d8 + 2) searching for a lost spellbook from its living days
11	1 **fire elemental myrmidon**† guarding 1 **azer** (attitude for both: 1d6 + 2) that is gathering metal or other raw material
12	1 **phoenix**† (attitude: 1d8 + 3) traveling to or from a site of great devastation

†Monsters marked with a dagger (†) appear in *Monsters of the Multiverse*. Roll a d10 if you don't have that book.
*See chapter 6.

Elemental Water Encounters

d12†	Encounter
1	A coven of 3 **sea hags** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) trying to peer into the future
2	1 **cult fanatic** and 2d6 **cultists** of Evil Water (all with swimming speeds of 30 feet and the ability to breathe water), with 1d2 **chuuls** (attitude for all: 1d4 +1)
3	1 **rime hulk*** (attitude: 1d6) wailing and stalking
4	1 **storm crab*** (attitude: 1d8) traveling in a straight path with purpose
5	1 **frost giant of Evil Water*** (attitude: 1d6) considering going on a rampage
6	1 **marid** singing as it lounges with 1 **water elemental** (attitude for both: 1d10)
7	1 **hydra** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) hunting
8	2 **water weirds** (attitude: 1d8) keeping watch in small pools
9	1 **dragon turtle** (attitude: 1d12) searching for an advantage against a rival kraken
10	2 **water elementals** (attitude: 1d10) diligently making furrows in the sand using their bodies, creating a sprawling pattern
11	2 **water elemental myrmidons**† (attitude: 1d6 + 2) barring a passage or portal
12	1 **leviathan**† (attitude: 1d8) swimming through an exceptionally high tide

†Monsters marked with a dagger (†) appear in *Monsters of the Multiverse*. Roll a d10 if you don't have that book.
*See chapter 6.

Fiendish Incursion Encounters

Use the Fiendish Incursion Encounters table for situations where giants have turned from the gods of the Ordning to serve fiends (as described in chapter 2), where the ancient magic of long-fallen realms of giants opened portals to the Lower Planes (either intentionally or by accident), where magic runes have gone horribly awry and unleashed fiendish corruption into the world, or where fiends seek powerful allies to aid their schemes among mortals.

Fiendish Incursion Encounters

d10	Encounter
1	1d4 **barlguras** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) capering around a blasphemous idol
2	1 **arcanaloth** (attitude: 1d12) searching for a tempting bit of lost lore
3	2 **chain devils** (attitude: 1d6) suspending corpses on spiked chains
4	1 **fury of Kostchtchie*** performing a rite with 2 **trolls** (attitude for all: 1d6)
5	1 **echo of Demogorgon*** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) building a two-headed effigy from corpses
6	1 **stalker of Baphomet*** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) and 2 **minotaur** cultists (attitude: 1d4 + 1) stalking a **scout** (attitude: 1d10 + 4)
7	1 **maw of Yeenoghu*** with 4 **gnolls** and 4 **hyenas** (attitude for all: 1d4 + 1), all stalking prey
8	1 **marilith** (attitude: 1d4 + 2) searching for a renowned giant smith to forge six new swords
9	1 **cambion** (attitude: 1d8) trading verbal jabs with 1 **succubus** (attitude: 1d12)
10	1 **fire hellion*** (attitude: 1d6) conjuring 1 **bone devil** (attitude: 1d12) into a red-hot iron circle

*See chapter 6.

Listen. I have glimpsed the pages of Iggwilv's Demonomicon. I've felt the soul-chilling touch of an incubus. I've even ventured to more than one of the Lower Planes. Somehow none of these things compares to the sheer horror of a giant transformed into something much, much worse by the corruption of a demon lord.

—Bigby



Abandoned by Annam, some fire giants turn to devils to understand their place in the cosmos.

Giant Construct Encounters

Use the Giant Construct Encounters table to populate ancient giants' ruins that have been sealed from the outside world for millennia or hostile environments without breathable air. The creatures in these encounters might also act as servitors to magically powerful giants or serve as a reminder of the forgotten magic of ancient giants.

You can alter the appearance of any Construct on this table to reflect the nature of its creators. An iron golem built by fire giants might spew embers and sooty smoke between its iron plates, while one built by cloud giants might leak wisps of mist and raindrops. Any of these Constructs might have Giant runes engraved somewhere on them as part of the magic that animates them. You can alter any Construct's size without changing any of the creature's other statistics.

Giant Construct Encounters

d10†	Encounter
1	1 **runic colossus*** (attitude: 1d6) slowly rousing from a dormant state
2	2d4 **animated armors** (Large) and 1 **rug of smothering** (attitude for all: 1d6) keeping watch
3	1 **iron golem** (attitude: 1d6) patrolling
4	1 **shield guardian** (attitude: 1d12) searching for its master
5	1 **stone golem** (attitude: 1d6) crudely carved to resemble a hill giant
6	1d4 + 1 **helmed horrors** (attitude: 1d8) in a partially dormant state, as if asleep
7	2 **flesh golems** (Large; attitude: 1d6) made from ogre corpses stitched with copper wire
8	1 **clay golem** (attitude: 1d6 + 6) awaiting the fulfillment of a verse of ancient prophecy, which the characters could fulfill
9	1 **cadaver collector**† (attitude: 1d8) gathering bodies destined to become a flesh colossus (described in chapter 6)
10	1 **retriever**† (attitude: 1d6) searching for a thief who stole a Giant rune

†Monsters marked with a dagger (†) appear in *Monsters of the Multiverse*. Roll a d8 if you don't have that book.
*See chapter 6.

Giant Kin Encounters

The Giant Kin Encounters table presents a range of creatures of the Giant type that are not encompassed by the ordning, along with related creatures that might be pursuing their own schemes or working as part of a giant's machinations. These giant kin might be drawn to runes and sites of giant power, even long after the creators of those sites are gone.

Giant Kin Encounters

d10†	Encounter
1	A band of 2d6 **ogres** (attitude: 1d6) fawning over enormous Giant runes inscribed in the ground
2	1d4 **cyclopes** (attitude: 1d10) tending a herd of sheep
3	1 **troll** and 2d4 **orcs** (attitude for all: 1d8) scouting new settlement locations
4	1 **troll mutate*** (attitude: 1d6) drawing, scratching, or painting with too many claws
5	1d4 **firbolg primeval wardens*** (attitude: 1d12) making camp
6	1d4 + 1 **fensir skirmishers*** (attitude: 1d6 + 2) frantically gathering and hunting food to stockpile
7	1 **firbolg wanderer*** (attitude: 1d8) reluctantly bargaining with 1 **green hag** (attitude: 1d8 + 3)
8	2 **ettins** (attitude: 1d8) playing cards, with each head as an individual player in a four-player game
9	2 **ogre chain brutes**† (attitude: 1d4 + 1) demolishing a small structure
10	1 **dire troll**† (attitude: 1d6) eating a dead troll before it regenerates

†Monsters marked with a dagger (†) appear in *Monsters of the Multiverse*. Roll a d8 if you don't have that book.
*See chapter 6.

My brothers will scoff and tell you that these giant kin don't matter, that they don't count in the ranking of the ordning, that they're irrelevant to the world. But they DO matter, and you overlook them at your peril—not just the danger they pose as foes, but the value they can bring as allies.

—Diancastra

MICHELE GIORGI

Giant Necropolis Encounters

Use the Giant Necropolis Encounters table to populate places where giants once thrived that have been destroyed, fallen into decline, or succumbed to necromantic magic. The meddling of death giants or the planar influence of the Shadowfell might cause a giant enclave to decay quickly into a necropolis where creatures such as the ones on this table flourish.

Even without a theme of undeath, you can use these encounters to add a flavor of despair or to suggest Undead giants are interested in a location for mysterious reasons.

Giant Necropolis Encounters

d10	Encounter
1	1 **young red shadow dragon** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) seeking treasures steeped in sorrow
2	2 **cairnwights*** (attitude: 1d6 + 3) critiquing each other's artistic works in progress
3	1 **barrowghast*** and 2 **zombies** (attitude for all: 1d4 + 1) prowling for living creatures to slay
4	1 **frostmourn*** (attitude: 1d8 + 1) contemplating the many notches on its greataxe
5	1d4 **shadows** (attitude: 1d8) playing out the last moments of their lives as a shadow puppet show on a wall
6	2d6 **zombies** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) shuffling listlessly, following a path of Giant runes painted in dried blood
7	1 **firegaunt*** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) killing and destroying, desperately hoping someone will end its existence
8	1 **flesh colossus*** (attitude: 1d6) marked with the Giant rune of death, defending the crumbled ruins of the place it was created to protect
9	1 **tempest spirit*** (attitude: 1d6) searching for lost magical knowledge
10	1 **spectral cloud*** (attitude: 1d12) wandering with a ghostly green lantern

*See chapter 6.

Megafauna World Encounters

The Megafauna World Encounters table suggests encounters with gigantic animals that might appear in a "lost world" where long-forgotten versions of modern animals still thrive. It could also reflect a world where not only giants but everything—from domestic animals to plant life—is vastly oversized (see "Into the Giant Realms" in the "Adventure Models" section later in this chapter).

As with the dinosaurs on the Dinosaur World Encounters table, you can add a variety of trappings to the animals encountered here to reflect the nature of the giants who care for them.

Megafauna World Encounters

d10†	Encounter
1	2d4 **giant oxen*** (attitude: 1d6 + 4) grazing on shrubs, trees, or thatched roofs
2	1d3 **titanotheres*** (attitude: 1d8 + 3) roaming; one of them scratches an itch on trees, uprooting them in the process
3	1 **giant goose*** (attitude: 1d8) running with an item from a hill giant's bag (see "Giant Bags" in chapter 5) in its mouth
4	2 **mammoths** (attitude: 1d6) locking tusks in a territory dispute
5	1 **gigant*** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) rampaging
6	1d4 **saber-toothed tigers** (attitude: 1d10) stalking near a herd of 2d4 **giant elk** (attitude: 1d6 + 3)
7	1 **purple worm** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) following vibrations toward food
8	2d6 **giant ticks*** (attitude: 1d4 + 1) sucking the last blood from a giant's corpse
9	1 **froghemoth**† (attitude: 1d6) trying to hide somewhere comically inadequate for its bulk
10	1 **gray render**† (attitude: 1d6 + 3) gnawing the scenery

†Monsters marked with a dagger (†) appear in *Monsters of the Multiverse*. Roll a d8 if you don't have that book.

*See chapter 6.

Too much of the legacy of my people is death and decay. Too many of us brood on the past or haunt our dusty ruins. Can we not focus on the glories that lie ahead, instead of dwelling on the glory we have lost?

—Diancastra

Perhaps the sad truth is that memory, however distant and distorted it might be, is more powerful than imagination.

—Bigby

Adventures

Giants often appear in adventures that aren't about giants, serving as powerful enemies or allies to adventurers. This section offers inspiration if you want to make giants or the realms they inhabit a central element of an adventure. This section has two parts:

"Adventure Models" outlines five categories of adventures to help you think about the role you want giants to play.

"Giant Patrons" explores various roles a giant might adopt as a patron for an adventuring party and the missions the giant might assign.

Adventure Models

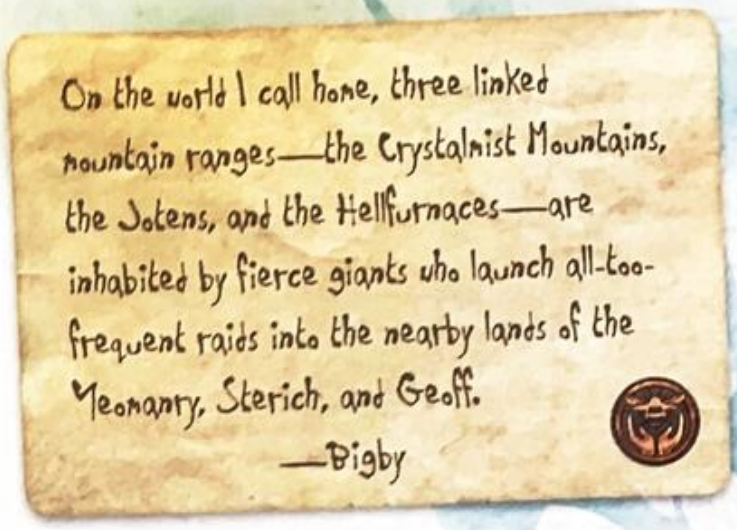
Giants serve as adversaries in many D&D adventures, but that's not the only possible role for them in your game. This section outlines five broad categories of adventures, including suggested adventure hooks for each category.

Against the Giants

Three of D&D's earliest published adventures featured giants as the primary opponents: *Steading of the Hill Giant Chief*, *The Glacial Rift of the Frost Giant Jarl*, and *Hall of the Fire Giant King*. (They were originally published in 1978, compiled together as *Against the Giants* in 1981, and reprinted multiple times in the decades since, most recently in 2017's *Tales from the Yawning Portal*.) The premise of these adventures is simple: "giants have been raiding civilized lands," so adventurers are assembled "to punish the miscreant giants." The adventurers fight their way up the ordning until their final confrontation with the fire giant king—and the revelation that the giants are merely pawns in the schemes of some sinister drow.

An adventure focused on giants as adversaries could involve a sustained battle against giants of a single kind (as each of the individual adventures in *Against the Giants* did), or it could involve progression through groups of different kinds of giants (as *Against the Giants* pitted characters against hill, frost, and fire giants in sequence). Alternatively, an adventure could involve giants of different kinds working together, perhaps united as members of a religious order or some other kind of organization that crosses the divide of giant kinds (see "Gods and Religion" and "Organizations," both in chapter 2).

The Against the Giants table offers suggestions for adventure hooks you can use to build an adventure following this theme.



Against the Giants

d8	Adventure Hook
1	Adventurers find a village completely deserted, with tracks leading to a hill giant steading. Can they rescue the surviving villagers and livestock before the hill giants eat them all?
2	A family of stone giants fell under the sway of Lolth and allied with Lolth-worshiping drow to raid the surface. Adventurers must break the alliance or eliminate the stone giants if necessary.
3	An especially harsh winter is accompanied by roving bands of frost giants and winter wolves preying on travelers.
4	Fire giants send hell hounds into mine tunnels to chase the miners out, then send their own azer servants to plunder the mineral-rich mines. The miners seek help to reclaim their mines.
5	A clever cloud giant plays several other powerful creatures against each other and against nearby Humanoids. Eliminating the giant will return the volatile situation to an uneasy status quo.
6	A frost giant leads a mixed band of weaker giants in a campaign of bloodlust to honor Thrym or a demon lord.
7	After a villainous group slays a young storm giant, the giant's parent unleashes an undiscriminating campaign of vengeance against any "interfering little gnats" living nearby.
8	As characters explore a steading belonging to one kind of giant (you can roll a d6 on this table to decide why the characters are there), they discover an honored guest of a more powerful giant kind who is coordinating the weaker giants' activities.

Clash of Titans

Sometimes giants are background elements to an adventure that has more to do with the impact of the giants' actions on the world than it does with the giants themselves. These adventures might be disaster stories, where characters might help bystanders escape. The source of the disaster might be a conflict between two giants (or two groups of giants), a clash between a giant and another powerful monster (such as a dragon, a dinosaur, a purple worm, or the tarrasque), or the stirring of a truly colossal giant (such as the scions of giants' gods described in chapter 6). An adventure might also challenge characters to drive the giants (and other forces of destruction) away from settled lands.

The giant in a scenario like this need not be the villain. A storm giant wrestling a kraken to keep the creature from destroying a coastal city might still cause accidental devastation. A giant might look for heroes to take care of bystanders while the giant deals with (or holds back) the greater threat.

The Clash of Titans table provides a sampling of adventure hooks you can use to build an adventure along these lines.

Clash of Titans

d6	Adventure Hook
1	Frost giants besiege a fire giant settlement, disrupting travel and trade across the region. Injured frost giants shelter in nearby towns, demanding the people there serve them while they recover.
2	A dragon and a giant, in the middle of a fierce battle, suddenly fall from the sky into a town square. Neither combatant is concerned about protecting the people around them.
3	Hired to guard a caravan heading to a remote mountain town, adventurers find the pass blocked with rockslides caused by stone giants at play.
4	A group of giants (perhaps members of the Stewards of the Eternal Throne, described in chapter 2) warns a city that the tarrasque is approaching and asks for heroes to evacuate the city while the giants hold the monster at bay.
5	A terrifying storm lashes a fishing village for days. After helping people get to safety, the adventurers investigate the storm, and they discover a storm giant locked in battle with a kraken nearby.
6	After slumbering for centuries, a scion of Grolantor (described in chapter 6), begins to stir. The residents of the farming village built on the sleeping giant's back seek help evacuating.



A giant and a dragon are oblivious to the destruction they're causing.

Delve into the Past

In the world of Eberron, the continent of Xen'drik is the ancestral home of giants and the location of their ancient empire. The continent is littered with the cyclopean ruins of this forgotten civilization, and now scholars and treasure hunters mount expeditions to plunder the ruins and unearth the secrets of the giants. On other worlds, the ruins of ancient giants' civilizations might not be as numerous or well known, but you can still build adventures that lead characters to explore the realms of past giants.

An expedition into giants' ruins might involve a confrontation with giants, or it might mean facing whatever monsters have taken up residence in the ruins in the centuries since the giants abandoned them. In Xen'drik, living giants still inhabit some of their ancient ruins, though they have fallen far from the height of their civilization. Ruins might be inhabited by the once-giant hulks or Undead giants that appear in chapter 6, by Constructs crafted by giants, or by any kind of creature that has taken shelter in the ruins—potentially including enormous creatures, such as dragons, that appreciate the roomy chambers crafted by ancient giants.

You can use the Delve into the Past table to inspire adventures leading characters into ancient giant ruins. You can also use the locations in chapter 4 as destinations for these adventures; each of those locations includes its own suggested adventure hooks that you can use instead, or combine with the ones here, as inspiration strikes you.

Delve into the Past

d6	Adventure Hook
1	During a long drought, the water level of a lake lowers, revealing huge structures at its bottom.
2	A sinkhole releases strange monsters into the surface world, and characters who investigate discover a ruined stronghold in its depths.
3	An eccentric aristocrat finances an expedition to a remote ruin to retrieve giant-made art and artifacts.
4	The characters' research suggests the last known location of the *Axe of the Dwarvish Lords* (or some other artifact they want to retrieve) was in an ancient giant stronghold.
5	Adventurers tracking a monster discover its lair in an ancient giants' ruin. While they hunt the monster, they can also piece together the history of the place.
6	Characters exploring a strange ruin accidentally trigger magic that causes seven flying castles—including the one the characters are in—to rise into the sky from where they had fallen.

Giant-Sized Schemes

Giants are mythical creatures, descended from a god and imbued with the raw energy of the Elemental Planes. But they're also people whose relationships, ambitions, emotions, and subterfuge are literally larger than life. The intrigue among storm giant King Hekaton's daughters in *Storm King's Thunder* is an example of how interpersonal dramas can shake the whole world when they play out on the stage of a giant's realm.

The Giant-Sized Schemes table offers suggestions, including several inspired by the plots of famous dramas.

Giant-Sized Schemes

d6	Adventure Hook
1	The ghost of a murdered giant monarch appears to the monarch's heirs and demands they claim vengeance. The heirs and the murderer end up in a wide-ranging conflict that threatens to devastate settlements near the giants' realm.
2	Convinced she is the rightful ruler of another giant's domain, a giant launches an invasion, heedless of the inhabitants of the lands between the giants' realms.
3	Believing his sovereign has violated the ordning by promoting an inferior giant instead of him, a scheming giant hires adventurers to undermine the sovereign's authority.
4	Seeking to impress a fire giant, a frost giant tries to bind a powerful elemental, but the elemental escapes and rampages across the region.
5	A dejected storm or cloud giant causes a drought or flooding across nearby farmlands.
6	After being insulted by a giant sovereign, a noble giant schemes to open a portal to the Abyss and summon a demon lord to destroy the sovereign's settlement. The site becomes a festering sinkhole of evil as demons roam the surrounding area.

> The best reason for delving into the past is to discover a path to a better future.
>
> —Diancastra



THREE BRAVE URCHINS SEEM TO HAVE STEPPED THROUGH THE WRONG DOORWAY IN WATERDEEP!

Into the Giant Realms

In Jonathan Swift's novel *Gulliver's Travels*, the protagonist is swept off course on a sea voyage and finds himself in the land of Brobdingnag, where everything is twelve times its usual size, from people to rats. In Jules Verne's *Journey to the Center of the Earth*, explorers discover a subterranean world where giant-sized people tend herds of mastodons and where reptiles from Earth's ancient past still roam the sea and sky. The English fairy tale of Jack climbing a beanstalk to a giant's cloud castle is a similar example of an adventurer passing into a world of giants. In Norse myth, giants inhabit the realm of Jotunheim, where brave gods and heroes occasionally venture on dangerous quests.

An adventure inspired by these tales might see characters discovering a secret valley hidden in a remote mountain range where storm giants tend flocks of sheep the size of horses, delving deep into the Underdark where stone giants ride mammoths across vast subterranean plains, washing up on an uncharted island whose giant inhabitants hunt dinosaurs, or entering a demiplane where a portion of the ancient world of the giants is perfectly preserved. The characters might be lost travelers or bold explorers, or they might journey to these wondrous locations in search of some treasure or powerful magic used by the giants.

The Into the Giant Realms table offers more suggestions for how to bring characters to these realms.

Into the Giant Realms

d6	Adventure Hook
1	A fissure opens during an earthquake, and ordinary means can't determine its depth. Adventurers are asked to explore it and determine the source of the light that is barely visible far below.
2	Characters find a coded journal in a dragon's treasure hoard, indicating a path to a hidden paradise.
3	Adventurers find a giant-sized ring inscribed with the sigil sequence for a teleportation circle.
4	An enormous stone archway is carved with symbols that, when touched in the correct sequence, activate a portal.
5	A strange map shows a road where no road exists. During solstices, the road appears and stretches in an impossible direction to a mysterious destination.
6	Characters acquire a broken piece of an artifact that magically guides them to the location of another piece, which is in a realm of giants.

Giants of Surtland. Surtland is an example of a realm of giants inspired by Norse myth. This realm is one of ten worlds that make up the MAGIC: THE GATHERING setting of Kaldheim, all moving among the branches of a vast World Tree. Wintry Surtland is a realm of constant turmoil. Volcanoes burst through snow and ice to form new mountains as the bitter cold freezes steaming geysers into sprays of ice shards. Earthquakes and volcanic eruptions reshape the landscape almost daily. Avalanches of snow and broken rock tumble down mountainsides and change the course of half-frozen rivers.

The frost and fire giants of Surtland are locked in constant conflict. The frost giants prefer to be left alone, but they also claim the best, safest territories in the realm, building gleaming ice palaces on high mountain peaks and glacier fields. In addition, they hoard treasures and arcane secrets for themselves. The fire giants build shelters in the lowlands, where lava fissures carve paths through wide fields of snow, and the fire giants gather in bands to attack the frost giants.

At times, the worlds of Kaldheim overlap as they move around the World Tree. Such an overlap—called a Doomskar—is an explosive event marked by world-altering earthquakes and geological destabilization. You can use the idea of a Doomskar to bring Surtland (or a realm like it) into contact and conflict with your campaign world. During the Doomskar, characters can venture into Surtland, but giants can also raid into the other world.

GIANT PATRONS

Many of the adventure hooks throughout this book involve giants asking characters for help or hiring them to carry out a task. This section outlines long-term patron roles giants might fill.

If you want to use a giant as a patron for a group of adventurers, you can use the perks, contacts, and roles described in the "Group Patrons" chapter of *Tasha's Cauldron of Everything* alongside the adventure hooks and other information included here. Each of the roles described here corresponds (at least loosely) to a patron type described in that book, as shown on the Giant Patrons table.

GIANT PATRONS

Giant Role	Group Patron Type
Boss	Criminal Syndicate
Financier	Aristocrat
Seer	Ancient Being
Sovereign	Sovereign
Tutor	Academy
Warleader	Military Force

BOSS

A giant boss wields size and strength as tools to extract wealth and power from communities of smaller folk. The boss might threaten to harm adventurers or those they care about if they refuse to do the giant's bidding. Or the boss might recruit adventurers to share in the profits of a morally and legally questionable enterprise.

The archetypal giant boss is a hill giant, perhaps cleverer than most, who enjoys demonstrating just how superior a giant's strength is compared to smaller creatures. Such a boss might run a protection racket, a group of highway robbers, or a kidnapping ring. A giant boss might even take to a life of piracy, following in the enormous footsteps of Huzza, a hill giant in the world of the Forgotten Realms.

The Boss Assignments table suggests the kinds of missions a giant boss might send adventurers on.

BOSS ASSIGNMENTS

d6	Assignment
1	Thieves stole the giant's most precious treasure and fled into the sewers, where the giant can't follow. Hunt the thieves and retrieve the treasure.
2	A rival gang is encroaching on the giant's territory. Spy on these rivals, and identify the best place for the giant to strike to shut them down for good.
3	Somebody who works for the giant is stealing. Find out who it is, and make sure they never think about double-crossing the giant again.
4	The giant has a score to settle with a powerful foe (perhaps a dragon, a beholder, or another monstrous crime lord). Make sure the boss survives!
5	The boss wants a treasure that's being held in an underground refuge the giant can't enter. Plan and execute the perfect heist.
6	Another group of adventurers refuses to serve the boss anymore. Find them and convince them to return, or join forces with them to topple the giant.

FINANCIER

Armed with tremendous wealth, a giant financier pursues personal goals and interests that usually involve the acquisition of even greater wealth. Such a giant's appeal to adventurers is simply the promise of a steady salary and a luxurious lifestyle.

The archetypal giant financier is a cloud giant who constantly seeks to improve their standing in the ordning by amassing more wealth. The financier might back treasure-hunting expeditions into ancient ruins, prospecting missions to find valuable resources, or exploratory missions to map new lands or sea routes.

The Financier Assignments table suggests appropriate expeditions a giant might finance.

Financier Assignments

d6	Assignment
1	Follow a map found in an ancient tome to a long-forgotten ruin in search of treasure or lore.
2	Find a new route around or across inhospitable terrain such as a desert or ocean.
3	Delve into the Underdark in search of deposits of rare magical crystal, and map your route so miners can retrace it.
4	Sabotage the business of a rival giant.
5	Guard a wagon or caravan hauling goods to a remote settlement of giants.
6	Venture into a desolate wasteland to find the undiscovered ruined city at the center and identify the catastrophe that devastated the region.

Seer

A giant seer is guided by visions—glimpses of possible futures, messages from a god, or whisperings of some alien consciousness—and sends adventurers into the world to fulfill whatever those visions demand. The adventurers might share the giant's faith in whatever higher power is sending the visions, or they might be skeptical of the visions but enjoy the benefits of the giant's patronage.

The archetypal giant seer is a storm giant driven by the search for signs of Annam's activity. The seer might seek out omens written in natural phenomena, manipulate world events to bring about the fulfillment of prophecies, or work to prepare the world and its peoples for an impending catastrophe of apocalyptic scale.

The Seer Assignments table suggests quests a giant seer might lay on adventurers.

Seer Assignments

d6	Assignment
1	Help the giant re-create an ancient ritual that should reveal an omen or revelation from Annam.
2	Steal the research notes of some ancient sage (perhaps a dragon or a yugoloth), which hold information pertinent to Annam's activities.
3	Explore the ruins of an ancient temple to Annam, looking for records of revelations or prophecies.
4	Follow a devastating storm across the countryside, carefully mapping its path and cataloging the destruction left in its wake.
5	Brave a dragon's hoard to steal a device that tracks the positions of invisible celestial bodies.
6	Search for clues pointing to the location of the *Adze of Annam* (described in chapter 5) or some other artifact related to the gods of the Ordning.

Sovereign

A giant who rules over a settlement of other giants often needs Humanoid agents to act as emissaries to smaller peoples—and perhaps to enter locations where giants can't. Adventurers who fill such a role might do so out of loyalty to the giant sovereign, or they might be forced or bribed to serve the giant.

The archetypal giant sovereign is a fire giant who commands significant numbers of smaller folk, often including armies of Humanoids, as well as a community of giants. Adventurers in the sovereign's service might advance the giant's military, diplomatic, or clandestine goals on missions ranging from tactical assault to sabotage.

The Sovereign Assignments table lists some missions a giant sovereign might send adventurers on.

Sovereign Assignments

d6	Assignment
1	Steal intelligence from an enemy giant sovereign.
2	Weaken or remove a rival to the sovereign's rule—an ambitious general, fanatical priest, or jealous sibling.
3	Root out corruption or disloyalty among the giants, and eliminate their abuse of their strength to exploit the settlement's smaller inhabitants.
4	Bring gifts to a powerful dragon—and convince it not to destroy the settlement of giants.
5	Suppress (or secretly aid) an underground rebellion among the smaller folk of the settlement.
6	While pretending to entertain visiting diplomats, try to discover their secret reason for visiting.

Tutor

A giant who serves as a tutor to adventurers is often an exile from giant society, dwelling by necessity or choice among smaller folk and sharing the ancient wisdom of giants with them. Often, these giants are interested in pursuing esoteric studies of their own even as they share what they have learned with their eager students.

The archetypal giant tutor is a stone giant who is convinced the surface world—the world of dreams—has important wisdom to impart, just as the gods sometimes speak through dreams. The tutor might teach stone carving, runic magic, or the histories of the giants to eager students, while sending them on missions to gather wisdom from the dreaming world.

The Tutor Assignments table presents assignments a giant tutor might give to adventurous students.

Tutor Assignments

d6	Assignment
1	Capture and document the elemental hulks (see chapter 6) or other creatures that inhabit a remote valley, island, or cavern.
2	Explore the effects of a planar nexus on spellcasting, creatures, and magic items.
3	Delve into an ancient ruin to discover the nature of the plague, conflict, or magical catastrophe that exterminated the giants who once lived there.
4	Find the secret demiplane where an ancient city of giants was hidden to avoid catastrophe.
5	Find a set of artifacts that was plundered and scattered when a settlement of giants fell.
6	Plumb the secrets of a sect of giants that was wiped from the face of the earth by the gods' wrath.

Warleader

A giant warleader commands a military force, typically comprising many Humanoids, some number of lesser creatures of the Giant type (such as ogres, cyclopes, and ettins), and a few giants of the ordning. Adventurers might serve such a giant as skilled mercenaries or as part of this force.

The archetypal giant warleader is a frost giant commanding a horde of fierce soldiers. Adventurers in the warleader's service might participate in mass battles or more surgical strikes.

The Warleader Assignments table provides suggested missions the giant might assign.

Warleader Assignments

d6	Assignment
1	Take out a champion or commander at the rear of a mass of enemy forces.
2	Oversee the defense of a supply depot when enemies attack.
3	Sabotage or steal a powerful magical weapon before enemies can use it against the giant's forces.
4	Gather information on enemy troop numbers, placements, composition, or supply routes.
5	Protect the giant's forces from an attacking dragon.
6	Suppress the activities of bandits and rebels within the giant's territory.

I have learned a great deal from several important tutors in my life. My advice is to heed those whose minds are as expansive as their deeds.

—Bigby



ADVENTURERS EXPLORE A CH[illegible] OF PETRIFIED GIANTS.

BUD COOK

Campaigns

Giants exist (or once existed) in nearly every D&D world, but in the present age, they are generally confined to the margins. If you want to feature giants more prominently in the past or present of your campaign, this section offers inspiration to help.

A World of Giants

Your first decision in building a campaign world around the significant place of giants is whether the giants are flourishing in the present or inhabiting the ruins of their past.

Flourishing Giants

You might set your campaign in a world where giants still rule over smaller peoples—as Annam intended, the giants might say. This world could be the ancient past of a setting such as the Forgotten Realms or Eberron, where empires of giants thrived thousands of years ago. Or it could be a world of your own creation, perhaps one where giants have maintained an unbroken line of rule for countless generations. As you build such a world, consider these four key questions:

How do different kinds of giants live together? The world might have a single empire of giants where giants hold ranks based on their position in the ordning. Or several smaller realms might coexist in varying degrees of mutual hostility. Maybe storm giants have their own realm or realms, cloud giants their domains, fire giants theirs, and so on. Or there might be different realms that all include multiple kinds of giants.

What's the place of Humanoids? Perhaps the giants view themselves as stewards of the world, whose divinely appointed role is to protect and uplift the smaller peoples, and Humanoids live in the realms of giants as valued citizens. Or maybe Humanoids are new arrivals on the world, and the first intrepid adventurers are trying to carve out a place for their peoples in a hostile world. Humanoids might enjoy comfortable positions in some realms (particularly those ruled by cloud or storm giants) and be subjugated or hunted in other realms. Humanoids might align themselves (voluntarily or otherwise) with different giant kinds, allowing the giants of the ordning to serve as patrons or adversaries.

What's the role of dragons? In the Forgotten Realms and Eberron, ancient giants warred with dragons for control over the young world. Maybe in your setting, giants won a similar war, driving dragons into obscurity or even extinction. Perhaps such a war is still raging. Dragons might have their own realms alongside the nations of giants, coexisting in peace or in rising tension punctuated by occasional skirmishes. Alternatively, giants and dragons might have worked together to quash any opposition to their dominance over the world.

What's the role of the giants' gods? With the giants ruling the world as Annam intended, perhaps the All-Father hasn't turned his back on his children. He might be a much more active deity here, and giants might be more engaged in his worship and service. Or perhaps the giants rebuilt their ancient empire with the help of other powers, such as Elemental Evils, demon lords, or the dragon gods.

Shaped by Giants

You can also build a campaign that puts the focus on the world inhabited by the giants of old, which might or might not include a significant number of living giants. The core idea of such a campaign might be that giants dominate the history of the world, so they are responsible for all the ancient sites, magic, and treasures that populate your adventures.

A campaign built on this idea might have a post-apocalyptic feel, as Humanoids spread and begin to explore the ruins of a world destroyed by giants. Or the giants' empires might be an ancient mystery, totally forgotten in the modern world until an ancient site and its treasures are discovered and history is rewritten.

The dungeons and ruins adventurers explore might all be places built by giants. Some might instead be strongholds built by giants' enemies, such as underground fortresses where dwarves sheltered against giants' attacks. If exploring giant-sized dungeons is the norm, characters are likely prepared for climbing huge stairs and navigating other challenges of giant-sized locations (see chapter 4).

D&D worlds often assume some magic items (especially artifacts) were created in ancient times using long-forgotten techniques. You might decide such items in your campaign were made either by giants or by those who warred against giants. Magic items made by giants might magically adjust to fit smaller peoples, or skilled artisans might have learned techniques to alter these items. Chapter 5 offers more information and suggestions concerning magic items and other treasures crafted by giants.

Campaign Events

If you don't want to build a world that focuses on the presence or absence of giants, you can instead build a campaign around world-shaking events that are instigated by giants. *Storm King's Thunder* is an example: the events of this campaign-length adventure are set in motion by Annam's suspension of the ordning and by the scheming among the daughters of a storm giant king. Similar events might mark the

start, middle, or end of a campaign as the actions of giants shake the world.

The World-Shaking Events table offers inspiration for giant-driven events that can set or alter the course of your campaign.

World-Shaking Events

d8	Event
1	A giant who claims prophetic inspiration from Annam unites scattered bands of giants into a powerful political and militaristic force.
2	The death of a storm giant sets off a wide-ranging struggle among various giant leaders to fill the resulting power vacuum.
3	A cataclysmic disaster (such as a volcanic eruption, unending winter, or relentless storm) displaces both giants and smaller folk from their homes; only later do adventurers discover giants caused the disaster.
4	A mighty army led by giants launches an invasion of its neighbors, secretly motivated by the desire to access an ancient ruin in neighboring territory.
5	Humanoids mobilize to overthrow their giant oppressors, but the Humanoids are hopelessly outmatched in battle.
6	One of the giants' organizations described in chapter 2 is founded or comes to this world for the first time.
7	A group of giants sailing in enormous boats makes landfall in an area inhabited by Humanoids, marking each people's first awareness of the other and the lands they inhabit.
8	A small but growing number of giants believe the adventurers might be the fulfillment of an ancient prophecy that means they will bring about the return of Annam—and either the downfall or the resurgence of the giants.

Thousands and thousands of years we have walked these many worlds. Are we not too old and too wise for ancient grudges?

—Diancastra

Giants and Other Ancients

In the mythic history of most D&D worlds, giants occupy a privileged place—alongside dragons—among the first sapient creatures to walk the earth. Elves and dwarves arose or arrived on most worlds later, and other peoples are generally considered by these ancient folk to be younger in terms of the history of these worlds. Considering the relationships among these ancients—both in history and in their current form—can be an interesting way to develop a campaign that prominently features giants.

Ancient History

The history of the giants and these other ancient peoples doesn't need to be important in your world, but it might have long-lasting implications. In the Forgotten Realms, giants and dragons sometimes nurse grudges against each other stemming from the Thousand-Year War that devastated their ancient empires millennia ago. Even for such long-lived creatures, twenty-five thousand years is a long time to hold a grudge. In your world, there might never have been conflict between giants and dragons, or they might have long ago set aside any lingering resentment. Perhaps giants and dragons banded together in ages past in a desperate effort to survive the rise of younger peoples. Or evil giants might have sided with chromatic dragons while good giants took up arms alongside metallic dragons in the long-running conflict between the children of Bahamut and the children of Tiamat.

Similarly, many D&D worlds feature an ancient history of conflict between dwarves and giants. This enmity is visible most clearly in certain magic items originally made by dwarves to be highly effective against giants (and other creatures of the Giant type): the *dwarven thrower*, *Whelm*, and the *Axe of the Dwarvish Lords*. Often this history of conflict is assumed to be simply a matter of fighting over territory, since both dwarves and giants often prefer to live in mountainous regions. But the myths told by both giants and dwarves on some worlds describe the conflict extending into the divine realms as well. The god Moradin, who is revered by many dwarves, is said to loathe the evil giant gods. But you might decide the dwarves and giants of your world have a long history of friendly relations, or that dwarves often side with good giants in opposition to the schemes and depredations of evil giants. Perhaps dwarves are frequently the subjects of giant-ruled realms in the mountains, living peaceful and prosperous lives under beneficent storm giant rulers or toiling in poverty under fire giant tyrants.

Most D&D worlds' histories don't include any particular animosity between elves and giants. Perhaps in your world, elves and giants have coexisted peacefully in separate regions of the world. Or



maybe they warred fiercely: an *elven thrower* (a spear that is otherwise identical to a *dwarven thrower* warhammer) might be a magic relic of those ancient battles. Perhaps elves and giants worked together to bring an end to evil dragons' dominion over the young world, and the two peoples maintain a sense of mutual respect.

War of the Ancients

You might also decide to create a campaign where the conflicts among the ancients, like the Thousand-Year War between giants and dragons in the Forgotten Realms, are not a matter of ancient history but a present reality. You could build an entire campaign in the shadow of such a conflict, which is basically taking the ideas described under "Clash of Titans" earlier in this chapter and extending them through many adventures.

The war might not be a simple two-sided conflict between giants and dragons. Perhaps elves, dwarves, good giants, and metallic dragons joined forces against a two-pronged assault from evil giants and chromatic dragons. Or war might be raging between dragons and elves while giants strive to protect smaller peoples from the fallout.

Other peoples and monsters might be involved. The war might be a largely subterranean clash between stone giants and mind flayers while dwarves and drow seek to escape the earth-shaking and cavern-collapsing aftershocks of battles. Or storm giants might combat krakens and other nightmares of the deep while coastal cities and merchant ships struggle to endure devastating storms and tidal waves.

The Thousand-Year War in the Forgotten Realms lasted a thousand years for good reason: neither giants nor dragons were ever particularly numerous, and actual skirmishes between giants and dragons were rare. For this reason, you could run a campaign where battles between the warring parties are isolated events along the lines of the world-shaking events described in "Campaign Events." You might begin the campaign with one such battle, have the adventurers spend months or even years dealing with the aftereffects of the cataclysmic battle, then send your campaign in a new direction with a second battle. Maybe a third, truly cataclysmic battle—in which the adventurers are now high enough level to participate in the combat and turn it in favor of one side or the other—brings the campaign to a close.

Giants of Myth

Another approach to making giants a significant part of your campaign is to feature them in the mythology of your world. Scions of giants' gods (see chapter 6) might feature prominently in these myths, as these examples illustrate.

Ancient Advocates

Giants stole secrets of knowledge and magic from the gods and shared them with Humanoids, thus helping the smaller folk build their first civilizations. For that crime, the giants have endured millennia of punishment at the hands of petty and vengeful gods. Some giants blame Humanoids for causing this punishment, but others still view helping and teaching smaller peoples as their responsibility. (Alternatively, maybe the giants were responsible for teaching Humanoids the evil use of magic and were justly punished for that sin.)

Earth Shapers

Whether it's recorded in revered myth, passed on as casual folklore, or simply fact, giants shaped the landscape in the earliest days of the world. Gigantic boulders scattered across a rolling moor weren't deposited by receding glaciers—they were dropped (or intentionally placed) by giants. A great canyon wasn't worn away by eons of erosion; it was formed when a tired giant dragged her axe behind her after a long day of hewing trees (or dragons). The basalt columns visible at low tide connecting an island to the mainland aren't the result of volcanic activity but rather the craft of ancient giants. A crater or lake might be the place where an ancient giant stepped, slept, or fell after trying to climb the stars to reach Annam's palace. Elemental magic might linger in these places, making them likely locations for dungeons or monster lairs. Carefully sifting through these tales and plotting the locations on a map might reveal the path some ancient giant walked across the land, pointing to the location of a great mystery at the beginning or end of that journey.

Gardens of Delight

In a world that is fundamentally inhospitable to life, giants are responsible for maintaining small areas where Humanoids can flourish. Perhaps storm and cloud giants control the weather to maintain small gardens of comfortable temperatures amid a world-spanning desert or frozen wasteland. The campaign might explore what happens to the inhabitants of one of these gardens when its giant caretaker falls ill or dies. Or the gardens might be the stuff of legend in a harsh world where the bravest explorers dare to search for them.

Giants Hold Up the World

Six scions of giants' gods literally hold the world together. Perhaps they're responsible for holding the continents above the ocean surface or supporting the dome of the sky, or they might keep the world together through magical means. In any case, if these titans were killed, the world would dissolve into the Elemental Chaos. (Giants of the Worldroot Circle, described in chapter 2, might be responsible for protecting these scions.)

The Never-Ending Saga

Though Annam granted her wish for divinity, Diancastra still roams the worlds of the Material Plane, continuing the whimsical adventures told in numerous sagas. She is a trickster figure whose curiosity, acquisitiveness, and wanderlust constantly get her into sticky situations—and whose cleverness and occasional exertion of giant strength always get her out of those situations. Though she often appears disguised as a young storm giant, she can just as easily appear as a human, elf, or gnome, making her true identity almost impossible to discern. She enjoys a variety of worldly pleasures and delights in the company of mortal creatures of all kinds. She loves to learn more spells, preferring spells of the enchantment and illusion schools.

Though her exploits seem to serve only her own desires, Diancastra does have a greater agenda: to convince Annam to emerge from his seclusion and restore the giants to their rightful place at the pinnacle of the created order. Adventurers who get caught up in her schemes might eventually have a hand in bringing about Annam's return—or preventing it!

The Six Sleepers

The world has six scions of giants' gods, near-divine titans who are sleeping until Annam awakens them. Their slumbering forms define the terrain features of a certain region of the world (or perhaps up to six regions if they are dispersed around the world). A prophecy suggests a means by which they might be awakened early, leading to the destruction of the world.

The Six-Story Mountain

At the center of the world is an enormous mountain that is the ancestral home of this world's giants. The mountain vertically embodies the ordning, from the foothills to the churning storm that perpetually roils above its sky-high peak. The giants were banished from this mountain in ancient times, and scions of giants' gods, angels, devils, or some other supernatural guardians watch over the place to make sure the giants don't return before Annam gives them leave. What secrets of the world's creation and ancient history are hidden in this mythic place?

